REVISED 29 OCTOBER 2026 · WEDDING FLOWERS CUT SUNDAY 30 MAY 2027

Allotment Bible update

Your questions folded into the plan: the calendar split by job, an 18-tray cold frame, a planter shopping list and a plot layout drawn to scale.

74 sweet peas, not 40
Your 34 Spring Sunshine join the original 40. They sow this week with the rest.

Cold frame: 18 trays
Every autumn sowing now fits, including the ones the Bible sent to mesh cages. Fullest on about 10 March (17.5 of 18).

4 planters, 1 needed now
Tulips first. Ranunculus by mid-February, sweet peas by mid-March. No extenders.

Poppies
Bridal Silk stays borderline for 30 May. Iceland poppies move from "won't" to "gamble", sown now anyway.

Assumptions to check. The gate is at the south end, in the middle. A "tray" is a standard 38 × 24 cm seed tray. The 34 Spring Sunshine are seed. Your planters have no base and are at least 25 cm deep. Tell me if any is wrong and I will redraw.

Calendar: each job on its own bar

The Bible's single orange bar is now five. Click a job to hide or show it. The dashed rose line is harvest day, 30 May.

S Sow · U Pot up · H Harden off · P Plant out · C Harvest (cut or pick)

Sow seed into trays, modules or root trainers, or straight into the bed.

Pot up move into a bigger pot. Corms and tubers go into pots first; seedlings that outgrow their cells move on.

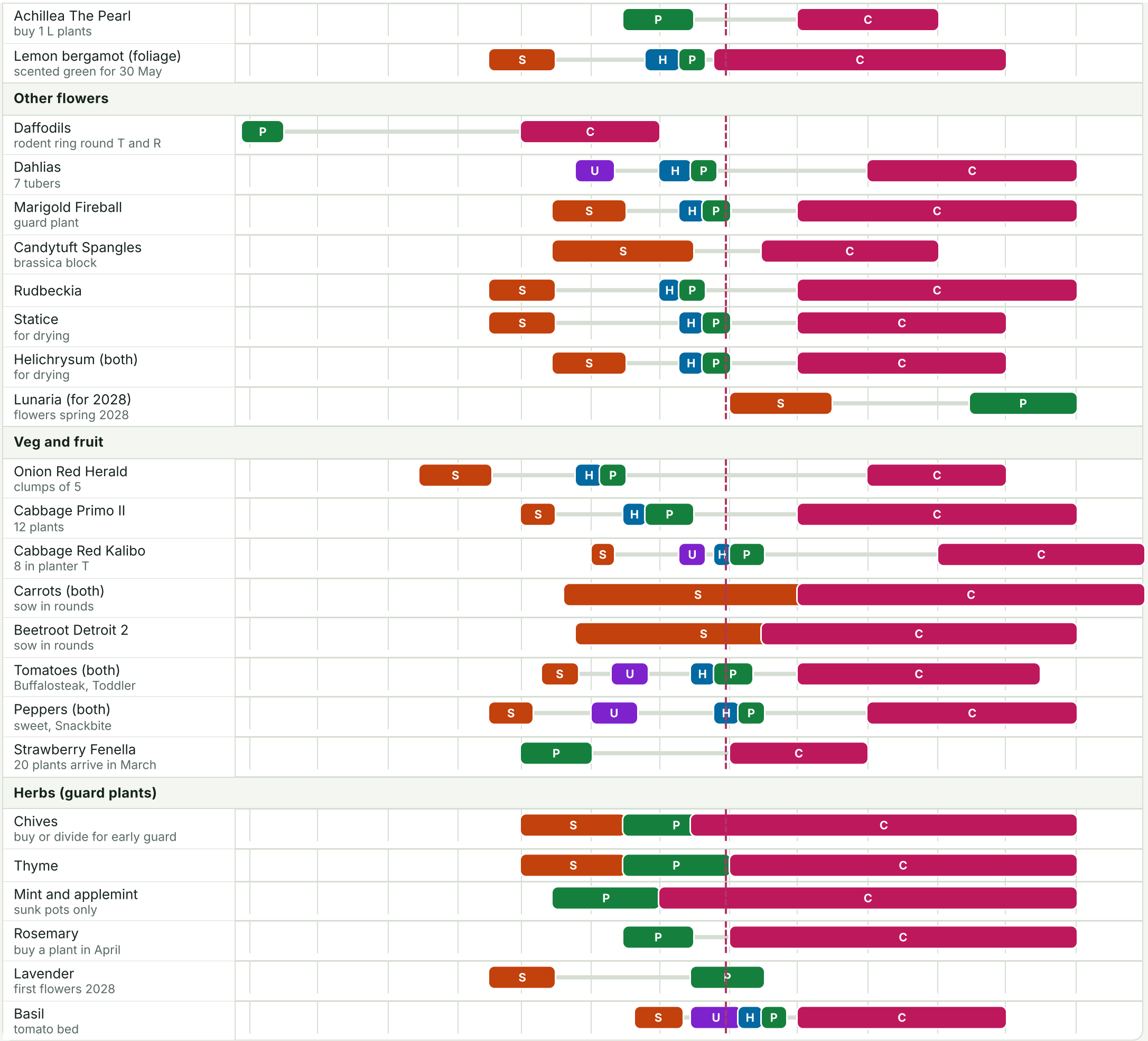
Harden off 7 to 10 days outdoors by day, in at night, before planting out.

Plant out into the final bed or planter. For bulbs this means planting them.

Harvest cut, pull or pick.

No pot up bar? Module to ground is fine. If a seedling fills its cell early, pot it on into 9 cm.

All plants | Wedding flowers | Other flowers | Veg and fruit | Herbs (guard plants)



Hover a bar for its dates. Thin grey lines join the first and last job of a plant. Dates are for mild southern England; move any of them by one to two weeks with the weather.

What to do, month by month

Built from the same data as the chart. Each job appears in the month it starts.

Oct 2026

FROM THE 29TH

SOW Sweet peas: Muse, Fire & Ice, High Scent, Sweet peas: Spring Sunshine
29 Oct–10 Nov

SOW Stocks, batch 1
29 Oct–5 Nov

SOW Larkspur, Clarkia, Orlaya, Nigella, Cornflower, Thlaspi, Poppy Bridal Silk, Iceland poppies (gamble), Scabiosa (gamble), Clary sage (if S. viridis)
29 Oct–15 Nov

PLANT OUT Tulips, batch 1
29 Oct–20 Nov

PLANT OUT Allium, Geum Cosmopolitan, Daffodils
29 Oct–15 Nov

- Tulips: lay mesh flat over the bed straight after planting and peg it every 20 cm.
- Alliums and chives: fleece or fine mesh over them. Leaf miner flies in Oct and Nov.
- Cold frame: line the base with 6 mm mesh, close every gap, mesh over each tray.
- Tulip batch 2: store in a lidded tin at 5 to 9 °C. Check weekly for mould.
- Buy snap traps, mesh, fleece, insect mesh and hoops. Order slug nematodes for March.

Nov 2026

POT UP Ranunculus, batch 1 (corms into trays)
1 Nov–8 Nov

- First frost (late Nov): lid on the frame, fleece over the trays inside.
- Start the weekly 5-minute rodent patrol.

Dec 2026

- Pinch sweet peas at 2 to 3 pairs of true leaves.
- Vent the frame on mild days. Fleece in frosts.
- Check stored bulbs for mould and gnawing, check every mesh, reset traps.
- Order the seed and plugs you still need.

Jan 2027

- **SOW** Onion Red Herald
  15 Jan–15 Feb
- **SOW** Didiscus
  25 Jan–15 Feb
- **PLANT OUT** Tulips, batch 2
  3 Jan–10 Jan

- Pinch any remaining sweet peas.
- Check the strawberry delivery date.

Feb 2027

- **SOW** Eucalyptus
  10 Feb–25 Feb
- **SOW** Stocks, batch 2
  15 Feb–28 Feb
- **SOW** Scabiosa (main sowing, windowsill), Lemon bergamot, Rudbeckia, Statice, Lavender
  15 Feb–15 Mar
- **SOW** Peppers
  15 Feb–5 Mar
- **POT UP** Ranunculus, batch 2 (corms into trays)
  20 Feb–28 Feb

- Ranunculus: soak corms 3 to 4 hours only. Longer rots them.
- Order slug nematodes if you have not.

Mar 2027

- **SOW** Cabbage Primo II
  1 Mar–15 Mar
- **SOW** Chives, Thyme
  1 Mar–15 Apr
- **SOW** Tomatoes
  10 Mar–25 Mar
- **SOW** Marigold Fireball, Helichrysum
  15 Mar–15 Apr
- **SOW** Candytuft Spangles
  15 Mar–15 May
- **SOW** Carrots
  20 Mar–15 Jul
- **SOW** Beetroot Detroit 2
  25 Mar–15 Jul
- **POT UP** Dahlias (tubers into 3 L pots)
  25 Mar–10 Apr
- **HARDEN OFF** Ranunculus, batch 1, Stocks, batch 1, Larkspur, Clarkia, Orlaya, Nigella, Cornflower, Thlaspi, Poppy Bridal Silk
  5 Mar–14 Mar
- **HARDEN OFF** Sweet peas: Muse, Fire & Ice, High Scent, Sweet peas: Spring Sunshine
  15 Mar–24 Mar
- **HARDEN OFF** Ranunculus, batch 2
  25 Mar–3 Apr
- **HARDEN OFF** Onion Red Herald
  25 Mar–5 Apr
- **PLANT OUT** Strawberry Fenella
  1 Mar–31 Mar
- **PLANT OUT** Ranunculus, batch 1, Stocks, batch 1, Larkspur, Clarkia, Orlaya, Nigella, Cornflower, Thlaspi, Poppy Bridal Silk
  15 Mar–25 Mar
- **PLANT OUT** Iceland poppies, Clary sage
  15 Mar–31 Mar
- **PLANT OUT** Mint and applemint (plants or divisions)
  15 Mar–30 Apr
- **PLANT OUT** Sweet peas: Muse, Fire & Ice, High Scent, Sweet peas: Spring Sunshine
  25 Mar–5 Apr
- **HARVEST** Daffodils
  1 Mar–30 Apr

- Slug nematodes on once the soil is above 5 °C.
- Netting up for larkspur, stocks and cornflower.
- Fleece alliums and chives again (leaf miner, Mar and Apr).
- Clarkia: pinch at 10 to 15 cm. Larkspur pinch is optional.

Apr 2027

- SOW — Cabbage Red Kalibo — 1 Apr–10 Apr
- SOW — Basil — 20 Apr–10 May
- POT UP — Eucalyptus — 1 Apr–15 Apr
- POT UP — Peppers — 1 Apr–20 Apr
- POT UP — Tomatoes — 10 Apr–25 Apr
- HARDEN OFF — Stocks, batch 2 — 1 Apr–10 Apr
- HARDEN OFF — Scabiosa — 1 Apr–14 Apr
- HARDEN OFF — Didiscus — 12 Apr–22 Apr
- HARDEN OFF — Cabbage Primo II — 15 Apr–24 Apr
- HARDEN OFF — Lemon bergamot — 25 Apr–9 May
- PLANT OUT — Ranunculus, batch 2 — 1 Apr–10 Apr
- PLANT OUT — Onion Red Herald — 5 Apr–15 Apr
- PLANT OUT — Stocks, batch 2 — 12 Apr–20 Apr
- PLANT OUT — Scabiosa — 15 Apr–25 Apr
- PLANT OUT — Achillea The Pearl (buy plants), Rosemary (buy plants) — 15 Apr–15 May
- PLANT OUT — Chives, Thyme (or buy a pot plant) — 15 Apr–31 May
- PLANT OUT — Didiscus — 23 Apr–30 Apr
- PLANT OUT — Cabbage Primo II — 25 Apr–15 May
- HARVEST — Thlaspi — 15 Apr–15 Jun
- HARVEST — Ranunculus, batch 1 — 25 Apr–25 May

- Fleece tender plants on frosty nights until May.
- Insect mesh on hoops over cabbages and carrots.
- Pinch cornflower, clarkia and orlaya.

May 2027

- POT UP — Cabbage Red Kalibo (optional) — 10 May–20 May
- POT UP — Basil (prick out) — 15 May–5 Jun
- HARDEN OFF — Dahlias — 1 May–14 May
- HARDEN OFF — Rudbeckia — 1 May–9 May
- HARDEN OFF — Eucalyptus — 5 May–14 May
- HARDEN OFF — Marigold Fireball — 10 May–20 May
- HARDEN OFF — Statice, Helichrysum — 10 May–19 May
- HARDEN OFF — Tomatoes — 15 May–24 May
- HARDEN OFF — Cabbage Red Kalibo — 25 May–31 May
- HARDEN OFF — Peppers — 25 May–4 Jun
- PLANT OUT — Lemon bergamot, Rudbeckia — 10 May–20 May
- PLANT OUT — Eucalyptus — 15 May–20 May
- PLANT OUT — Dahlias — 15 May–25 May
- PLANT OUT — Lavender — 15 May–15 Jun
- PLANT OUT — Marigold Fireball, Statice, Helichrysum — 20 May–31 May
- PLANT OUT — Tomatoes — 25 May–10 Jun
- HARVEST — Stocks, batch 1 — 1 May–10 Jun
- HARVEST — Mint and applemint — 1 May–31 Oct
- HARVEST — Tulips, batch 1 — 9 May–16 May
- HARVEST — Sweet peas: Muse, Fire & Ice, High Scent, Sweet peas: Spring Sunshine — 10 May–15 Jul
- HARVEST — Ranunculus, batch 2 — 15 May–15 Jun
- HARVEST — Orlaya — 15 May–30 Jun
- HARVEST — Nigella, Cornflower — 15 May–15 Jul
- HARVEST — Chives — 15 May–31 Oct
- HARVEST — Tulips, batch 2 — 20 May–23 May
- HARVEST — Allium, Stocks, batch 2 — 20 May–10 Jun
- HARVEST — Geum Cosmopolitan — 20 May–15 Jul
- HARVEST — Larkspur, Poppy Bridal Silk — 25 May–30 Jun
- HARVEST — Clarkia — 25 May–15 Jul
- HARVEST — Iceland poppies, Eucalyptus — 25 May–31 Jul
- HARVEST — Lemon bergamot (foliage) — 25 May–30 Sep

- Clear the fridge of fruit. Clean buckets and snips. Shade cloth ready.
- 29 May evening: take tulips out, re-cut 2 cm, stand in cold water.
- 30 May harvest day: cut early, sear poppy stems, condition cool and dark.
- 31 May: sort and arrange. 1 June: wedding.

Jun 2027

- SOW — Lunaria — 1 Jun–15 Jul
- HARDEN OFF — Basil — 5 Jun–14 Jun
- PLANT OUT — Cabbage Red Kalibo — 1 Jun–15 Jun
- PLANT OUT — Peppers — 5 Jun–15 Jun
- PLANT OUT — Basil — 15 Jun–25 Jun
- HARVEST — Scabiosa — 1 Jun–30 Sep
- HARVEST — Clary sage — 1 Jun–15 Jul
- HARVEST — Strawberry Fenella — 1 Jun–31 Jul
- HARVEST — Thyme, Rosemary — 1 Jun–31 Oct
- HARVEST — Didiscus — 15 Jun–31 Jul
- HARVEST — Candytuft Spangles — 15 Jun–31 Aug
- HARVEST — Beetroot Detroit 2 — 15 Jun–31 Oct

- Clear planters T and R once flowers finish.
- Strawberries ripen: net the bed and pick daily.
- Cut back lavender and thyme after flowering.
- Sow Iceland poppies and Lunaria for flowers in 2028.

Jul 2027

HARVEST Achillea The Pearl
1 Jul–31 Aug

HARVEST Marigold Fireball, Rudbeckia, Cabbage Primo II
1 Jul–31 Oct

HARVEST Statice, Helichrysum, Basil
1 Jul–30 Sep

HARVEST Carrots
1 Jul–30 Nov

HARVEST Tomatoes
1 Jul–15 Oct

- Cut and hang statice and helichrysum to dry.
- Last carrot sowing by mid-July. Take dahlia and rosemary cuttings.
- Order bulbs for next spring.

Aug 2027

HARVEST Dahlias, Peppers
1 Aug–31 Oct

HARVEST Onion Red Herald
1 Aug–30 Sep

Sep 2027

PLANT OUT Lunaria
15 Sep–31 Oct

HARVEST Cabbage Red Kalibo
1 Sep–30 Nov

- Lift and dry onions.

Oct 2027

- Cut dahlias until the first frost, then mulch 10 to 15 cm or lift and store.
- Pick Red Kalibo. Clear beds and rotate families.
- Plant next year's bulbs by late October.

Cold frame: 18 trays

The Bible assumed 8 trays, so it pushed cornflower, nigella and Thlaspi into mesh cages and left no room for your gambles. With 18, the whole autumn sowing lives in the frame under its mesh floor.

In the frame	5 Nov	Dec–Jan	28 Feb	10 Mar	1 Apr	20 Apr	10 May
Sweet peas ×74, root trainers	2.5	2.5	2.5	2.5	–	–	–
Stocks, batch 1	1.5	1.5	1.5	1.5	–	–	–
Stocks, batch 2 (back-up)	–	–	1	1	1	–	–
Larkspur, clarkia, orlaya	3	3	3	3	–	–	–
Nigella ×40, root trainers	1.5	1.5	1.5	1.5	–	–	–
Cornflower ×60 and Thlaspi ×20	1.5	1.5	1.5	1.5	–	–	–
Bridal Silk poppy ×30, root trainers	1	1	1	1	–	–	–
Gambles: Iceland poppy, scabiosa, clary sage	1.5	1.5	1.5	1.5	0.5	–	–
Ranunculus, batch 1 (about 40 corms)	1.5	1.5	1.5	1.5	–	–	–
Ranunculus, batch 2 (about 39 corms)	–	–	1.5	1.5	1.5	–	–
Cabbages (Primo II, Red Kalibo)	–	–	–	1	1	1.5	1.5
Dahlias ×7 in 3 L pots	–	–	–	–	2	2	2
Onion seedlings, hardening off	–	–	–	–	1	–	–
Tender plants, hardening off	–	–	–	–	–	3	6
Trays used (of 18)	**14**	**14**	**16.5**	**17.5**	**7**	**6.5**	**9.5**
Free	4	4	1.5	0.5	11	11.5	8.5

Tray-equivalents are my estimates: 24 modules, 40 plugs or about 32 root-trainer cells per tray footprint, rounded to half a tray. Measure your own and adjust.

If the frame fills up

Drop the gambles first (Iceland poppy, scabiosa, clary sage: 1.5 trays). Then raise Primo II cabbage on a windowsill and move it out in April.

Stays out of the frame

These need warmth to germinate, so they go on a windowsill or in a propagator: onions (mid-Jan), Didiscus (late Jan), peppers (15 Feb), eucalyptus, scabiosa main sowing, rudbeckia, statice, lemon bergamot and lavender (mid-Feb), tomatoes (mid-March), helichrysum (March) and basil (20 April). From April the frame is the hardening-off station for all of them.

Planters: how many, and what goes in

4 in total
Minimum 2 if the sweet peas go in the ground.

1 immediately
For the tulips, before about 20 November.

0 extenders
Tulips need about 25 cm of soil, including 8 cm under the bulbs.

6.5 m²
Planting area from four 180 × 90 cm planters.

Planter	Buy by	Holds	Guards mixed in	After the wedding
T Tulips	Now (plant by 20 Nov)	105 tulips: 95 plus 10 insurance at about 8 × 10 cm. Batch 1 in one half now, batch 2 in the other half in January. About 25 alliums between them.	Alliums are the guard here. Daffodils in the corners and in the ground ring around the planter.	June: 8 'Red Kalibo' cabbages with marigolds between.
R Ranunculus	Mid-February (plant out 15 Mar)	All 79 corms at about 13 cm. Batch 1 first, batch 2 in early April.	Chive clumps at both ends, thyme at the corners. Marigolds once the first corms finish.	June: late carrots and beetroot under insect mesh.
S1 + S2 Sweet peas	Mid-March (plant out 25 Mar)	74 plants, 2 per cane, on four rows of 2.4 m canes (10 canes a row). Capacity is 96.	Nigella, cornflower and orlaya underneath. Marigold or thyme at the ends. No chives or onions within a metre.	Pull in late July and sow green manure, or plant winter salads.

Why these, in this order

Rodents go for what they can dig up: tulip bulbs, ranunculus corms and sweet pea seedlings. Tulips go in first and cannot wait. Ranunculus and sweet peas live in the frame until March, so those planters can be bought later. Everything else (hardy annuals, stocks, poppies) goes in the ground as seedlings under mesh, which is cheaper.

Money-tight route: buy T now and R in February. Plant the sweet peas in a compost-enriched trench at the north end, with 6 mm mesh collars round the young plants until May.

Extenders

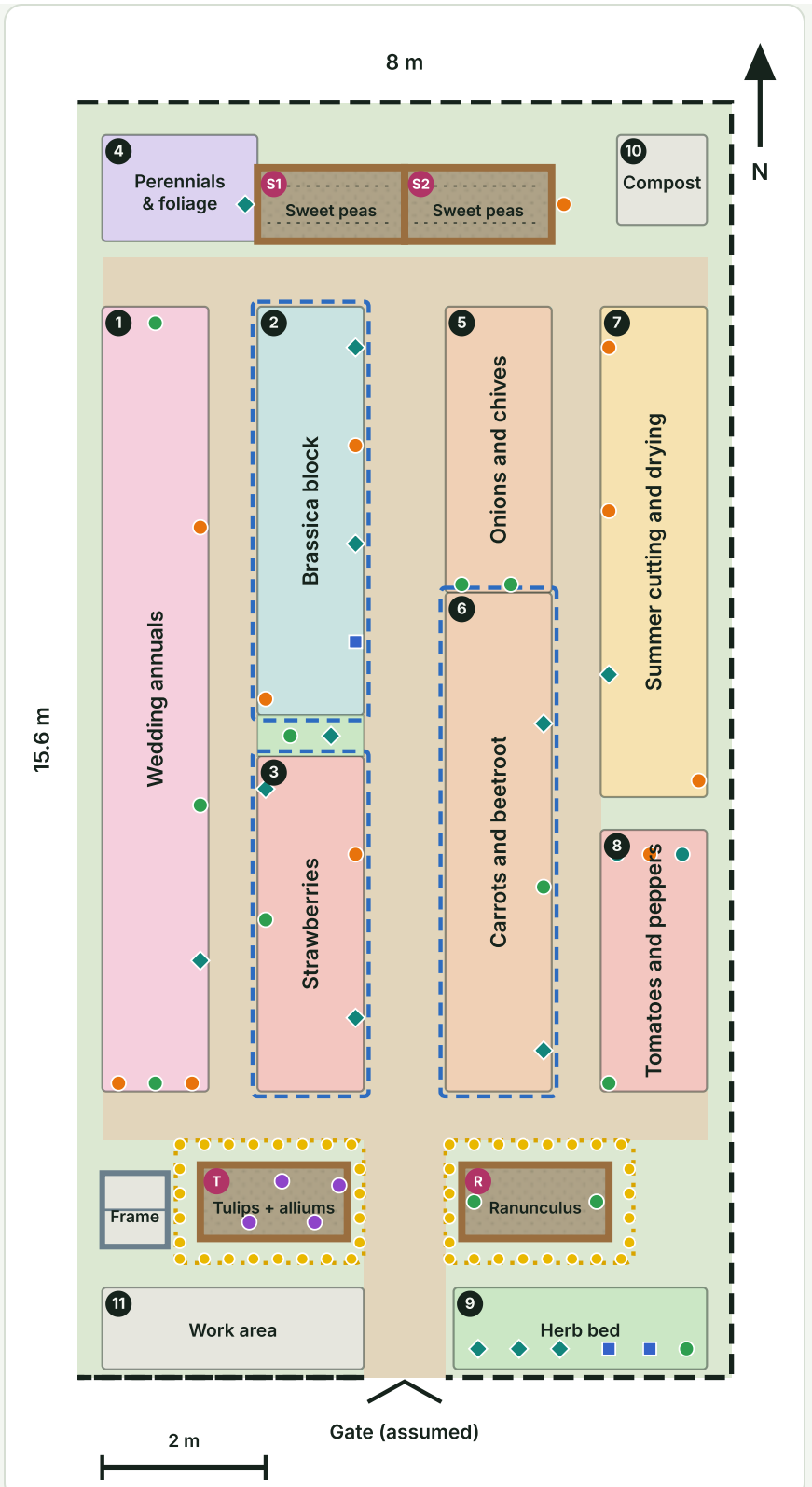
Skip them. In a planter the mesh lid protects the tulips, so they can go in at 10 to 15 cm instead of the 15 to 20 cm the Bible gives for open ground. Ranunculus go in at 3 cm. Sweet peas are fine in 25 cm. Only a planter shallower than about 20 cm would justify an extender.

Building each planter

1. Level the spot. Lay 6 mm galvanised mesh on the ground, 30 cm wider than the planter on every side, and set the planter on it.
2. Fold the mesh up the inside walls by 15 to 20 cm and fix it with staples, clips or zip ties. Overlap joins by 10 cm and wire them together. Budget about 3 m² of mesh per planter.
3. Fill with a mix of about half topsoil from your plot, a third compost and the rest grit. At 30 cm deep that is roughly half a cubic metre per planter, which is often the bigger cost than the planter itself.
4. For T and R, lay a mesh lid flat over the bed straight after planting and peg it every 20 cm. 25 mm stops squirrels; finer also stops mice but shoots must still push through. Take it off when growth is about 10 cm.

Plot layout

Drawn to scale on your 8 × 15.6 m plot, north at the top. Tall things sit at the north so they shade nothing. The tulip and ranunculus planters sit nearest the gate, because rodents avoid places people walk past. The brassica family shares one block, and carrots sit beside onions.



- Wedding flowers
- Summer cutting and drying
- Brassica block
- Roots and onions
- Perennials
- Fruit, tomatoes, peppers
- Herbs and guard strips
- Raised planter (wire mesh underneath)
- Insect mesh or net on hoops
- Daffodil ring (every 15 cm)
- Marigold
- Chives
- Thyme, rosemary, sage, basil
- Mint in a sunk pot
- Alliums

Paths: the 1 m main path and the 0.6 m side paths are wood chip over cardboard (tree surgeons give chip away). The 0.3 m edge strip is kept mown, so mice have no cover next to the beds.

Beds and planters

Bed	m²	What goes in	Why here
1 Wedding annuals	12.5	Larkspur, clarkia, orlaya, nigella, cornflower and Bridal Silk poppy at about 20 cm. Eucalyptus ×15 across the north end. Didiscus at the south end.	The wedding crop gets the best strip. It is also furthest from the carrots (orlaya and Didiscus are carrot family).
2 Brassica block	6.5	Stocks (3 varieties) and Thlaspi, then candytuft and Primo II cabbage. Insect mesh on hoops.	Stocks, Thlaspi, candytuft and cabbage share clubroot and flea beetle, so they stay in one block that moves each year.
3 Strawberries	5.3	20 Fenella in two staggered rows, net frame over the top.	Away from the geum (bed 4) and held off the brassicas by the guard strip.
4 Perennials & foliage	2.5	Geum ×5, achillea, clary sage, lemon bergamot.	Permanent bed in a corner, so it is never dug. North side, so it shades nothing.
5 Onions and chives	4.6	Red Herald onion clumps at 25 cm, chives along the south end.	Directly against the carrot bed: the onion smell masks the carrot smell.
6 Carrots and beetroot	7.9	Carrots in rounds, beetroot between. 80 cm insect mesh round the carrots.	Stone-free, unmanured, a metre or more from orlaya and Didiscus.
7 Summer cutting and drying	7.8	Dahlias ×7, rudbeckia, statice, helichrysum, scabiosa, marigolds between.	Planted after the last frost. Tall dahlias at the north.
8 Tomatoes and peppers	4.2	Buffalosteak and Toddler tomatoes, two peppers, basil and marigold.	South end: the warmest, sunniest spot, close to the gate for picking.
9 Herb bed	3.1	Rosemary, thyme, lavender, chives, mint and applemint in sunk pots (kept apart).	By the gate for picking. Cuttings and divisions from here feed the guard strips.
10 Compost	1.2	Two closed bins with a mesh base.	The far corner from the bulb planters. Open heaps feed rats.
11 Work area	3.2	Potting bench, water butt, tool box, boards stood 30 cm off the ground.	Next to the cold frame. Keep it tidy: stacked timber and old sacks shelter mice.
T Planter, tulips + alliums	1.6	105 tulips and about 25 alliums, daffodil ring around it. Nearest the gate.	Rodents avoid ground people cross.
R Planter, ranunculus	1.6	79 ranunculus. Chives at both ends. Nearest the gate.	Beside the cold frame, so corms go straight in.
S1 Planter, sweet peas	1.6	Sweet peas, 2 cane rows. The main path leads straight to them, so damage shows within days.	North edge: 2.4 m canes shade nothing.
S2 Planter, sweet peas	1.6	Sweet peas, 2 cane rows, 74 plants across S1 and S2.	North edge: 2.4 m canes shade nothing.
Cold frame	0.7	18 trays, 6 mm mesh floor, mesh strip over the vents.	South-west of the gate, next to the planters and the work area.

The Bible budgeted 95 m² of beds. At the spacings on its plant cards, your plant numbers need about 60 m², so the rest is paths and room to grow. Next year the brassica block moves to bed 1, and the wedding annuals move to bed 2's ground.

Where the guard plants go

Guard	Beside	Notes
Daffodils, alliums	Tulip and ranunculus planters	The strongest effect on the plot: rodents leave them alone. Daffodils every 15 cm in the ring, 10 to 15 cm deep.
Chives	Carrots, strawberries, ranunculus, brassica strip	Never within a metre of sweet peas. Fleece in Oct to Nov and Mar to Apr (leaf miner).
Thyme, rosemary, sage	Cabbages, carrots, strawberries, sweet pea ends	Scent may confuse egg-laying butterflies. A partial effect.
Mint, applemint	Beside the brassica block	Sunk pots only, and never side by side (they hybridise).
Marigold 'Fireball'	Brassicas, tomatoes, dahlias, planters after May	Hoverflies eat aphids. Planted out after the last frost, so from late May.
Basil	Tomatoes and peppers	Plant out mid-June.
Nigella, orlaya, cornflower	Sweet peas and stocks	Flowers that feed hoverflies and lacewings. They are also wedding flowers.

The Bible's evidence note stands: companion effects are modest, and mesh and netting do the heavy lifting.